

Anna Chandy was born in the princely state of Travancore, in present-day Kerala. One of the first female postgraduates in the state, Chandy qualified as a lawyer and set up a criminal law practice. She later became the first Malayalee woman to serve, successively, as a first-grade munsif (a type of judge), a district court judge and a high court judge. Vocal about women's right to education and work, she was firmly against child marriage and purdah. For her views, Chandy frequently earned the disapproval of her male colleagues and peers. Undaunted, she founded a weekly women's magazine in Malayalam named *Shrimati* that was dedicated to educating women about their rights.

"MY WISH IS THAT WOMEN SHOULD NOT BE WORSHIPPED LIKE GODDESSES. THEY MUST BE TREATED AS MERE MORTAL CREATURES…UNTIL THE DAY IN WHICH AN EVEN-HANDED STANDARD IS FORGED TO ASSESS BOTH [MEN AND WOMEN] THIS SORT OF GODDESS-WORSHIP REMAINS HOLLOW AND INANE."

THE MAHARANI OF TRAVANCORE

Anna Chandy was able to study law in the 1920s thanks to the forward-thinking queen of Travancore, Maharani Sethu Lakshmi